Ishan Shah

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Engineering Leader | Compute Platforms & Infrastructure Engineering at Scale | Multi-Cloud & On-Prem Kubernetes, CI/CD, IaC & Team Building

SUMMARY

Infrastructure and platform leader with 15+ years building compute platforms and the teams that run them. I've owned Kubernetes across AWS, GCP, and Azure plus on-prem/hybrid environments, designed CI/CD platforms and infrastructure-as-code, and built the "paved roads" that let engineering teams self-serve and ship safely at 99.99% reliability. I build and scale infrastructure organizations — growing small teams into specialized functions across SRE, developer productivity, incident management, and platform — and partner closely with security and data/AI teams. I run reliability with observability, SLOs, and blameless incident response; drive cost efficiency (>$200K saved on ~$2M cloud spend); and own security and compliance programs end to end (ISO 27001, SOC 2). Hands-on where it matters, and a mentor and hiring manager who raises the technical bar.

EXPERIENCE

CruxOCM Inc. — VP of Engineering / Head of Automation (reporting to the CTO) · Feb 2025 – Present

- **Infrastructure org & team building:** Lead a distributed engineering org across platform, infrastructure, DevOps, SRE, security, and quality; built and scaled the function from a small team into specialized areas (platform, developer productivity, incident/reliability, security), hiring and mentoring engineers and leads and setting the technical bar.
- **Compute platform — multi-cloud & hybrid:** Set compute-platform strategy and standardized Kubernetes as the control plane across GCP and Azure (plus hybrid cloud) with multi-tenant, GitOps-governed clusters and Terraform infrastructure-as-code; delivered self-service, ephemeral environments as "paved roads" that abstract infrastructure and cut developer friction.
- **CI/CD platform & automation:** Own CI/CD platform design across GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Bazel (monorepo), and Gradle with pipeline gating, artifact management, and release governance; built automation frameworks that eliminated manual ops toil and replaced ad-hoc processes with standardized tooling.
- **Reliability, SRE & incident management:** Run reliability with observability (Grafana LGTM — metrics, logs, traces — / OpenObserve, PagerDuty), SLOs, and blameless incident response and RCA at 99.99% uptime; own ~$2M cloud spend with >$200K saved through right-sizing and ephemeral infrastructure.
- **Security, compliance & cross-team partnership:** Spearheaded ISO 27001 and SOC 2 programs (audit ownership) with SBOM and static-analysis scanning; partner with security on hardened infrastructure and with data/AI teams — shipping production AI agents (GCP ADK) and MCP servers on the platform.

Insulet Corporation (FDA-regulated medical devices) — Sr. Cloud Engineering Manager · Dec 2022 – Feb 2025

- Led cloud and data-product teams (25–30 engineers) across platform, DevOps, developer productivity, and performance engineering; partnered with the VP of Engineering on multi-year roadmaps and quarterly OKRs.
- Owned end-to-end CI/CD with gating and one-button deploy (Jenkins, Python, Gradle); operated highly available Jenkins on EKS/EFS (99.9% uptime) and cut deployment errors 15%.
- Built a performance and load-testing framework (Locust, Python) on EKS/AWS (25% improvement); implemented SBOM generation and regulated change control for data integrity and supply-chain security.

Amazon (AWS Redshift) — Lead Systems Engineer · Dec 2016 – Dec 2022

- Owned the build, CI/CD, release ecosystem, and test tooling for Redshift — one of AWS's largest-scale distributed data services — including the CI/CD servers and fully automated build/deploy across all AWS-supported regions.
- Led the team that designed and shipped a Bors-style automated merge queue, gating integration on the exact merge candidate (not just the feature branch) — eliminating broken-mainline incidents and unblocking developer velocity org-wide.
- Added metrics-driven reporting on pipeline health and developer productivity, making bottlenecks visible and driving continuous improvement across the developer workflow.

Prosper Marketplace (regulated fintech) — Lead DevOps Engineer · Jan 2015 – Dec 2016

- Rolled out org-wide CI/CD with Jenkins and containerization with Docker; managed Artifactory artifact/versioning, SonarQube quality gates, and a Hadoop cluster on AWS (EMR) for large-scale data processing.

Pivotal Software — Member of Technical Staff · Sep 2011 – Jan 2015

- Managed CI infrastructure and agents; migrated Perforce to Git with enforced branching/merge policy; automated Coverity static analysis and code-coverage; built dynamic provisioning of Linux environments across AWS and on-prem vCloud.

OPEN SOURCE

UniClaw · github.com/uniclaw-labs/uniclaw

- Architected and shipped UniClaw, an open-source AI agent platform — a multi-provider framework built on Claude-powered agents, a FastAPI (Python) backend, and a Tauri desktop app in React and TypeScript, with a security-first design (OAuth2 with scoped JWTs, rate limiting, Fernet-encrypted secrets, non-root containers) and 4,400+ automated tests across a polyglot codebase (Python, TypeScript, Rust). Also publish an open-source Lever MCP server.

EDUCATION

- M.S., Software Engineering, San Jose State University (2011)
- B.E., Computer Engineering, Gujarat University (2009)

SKILLS & TOOLS

- **Compute Platforms & Cloud:** Kubernetes (EKS, GKE, AKS); multi-cloud (AWS, GCP, Azure) & on-prem/hybrid; multi-tenant clusters; Docker; distributed systems at scale; capacity planning & cost efficiency
- **Infrastructure-as-Code & CI/CD:** Terraform; CI/CD platform design (GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Bazel monorepo, Gradle); GitOps; merge-queue & release governance; artifact management; Linux
- **Reliability & Operations:** SRE; observability (Grafana LGTM / OpenObserve, PagerDuty); SLOs; incident management & blameless RCA; 99.99% reliability; performance optimization
- **Platform Engineering & Team Building:** "Paved roads" / self-service internal developer platform; developer productivity & DORA; building & scaling infra teams into specialized subteams; hiring, mentoring & standards
- **Security & Compliance:** ISO 27001 / SOC 2 (audit ownership); SBOM & static-analysis scanning; security partnering; regulated-industry change control
- **Leadership:** Cross-disciplinary infra leadership; roadmaps & OKRs; ~$2–3M budget & vendor management; cross-functional partnership (Security, Data/AI, executives)
- **Software & Data:** Python; Java/C/C#; Bash; SQL/NoSQL (MySQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle, DynamoDB); API design